

Watcher v2 — Build Roadmap

From a message filer to a receptionist. Every item scored for urgency and ease. • 13 August 2026 • v1.12

The whole gap in one line: the pipeline can listen and file, but it cannot reply. Three outcomes exist and all three mean “put this somewhere”. Adding a fourth — **answer the customer** — is the project.

Where we stand today

Built and tested	Missing
228 passing tests, no DB or network needed 98 Python files, 13 modules 11 DB tables + migration Every external system behind a swappable seam Eval runner + job queue, with a CI accuracy gate Receptionist vocabulary: 19 intents, data not code Channel-neutral envelope + WhatsApp/voice adapters Task state machine and the autonomy gate	A reply path — the pieces exist, nothing is wired Persistence — tasks live in memory, not a table Knowledge — zero tables, zero rows A channel-neutral core — 8 files still say wa_ Live availability — no read path to any PMS Proof of identity — matching is not verifying

How to read the scores

NOW	Today or tomorrow. Something is actively bleeding, or it blocks other work.
HIGH	This sprint. The demo does not exist without it.
MED	Needed before a real client, not before a demo.
LOW	Do it when convenient. Nothing waits on it.
Trivial	Minutes. A setting, a click, a delete.
Easy	Understood problem, no design decisions left open.
Moderate	Real work, but the pattern already exists in the repo to copy.
Hard	Genuinely new. Nothing in the repo to copy from.

Totals: ~13 engineering days remaining by the numbers below — realistically 11 to 12, because 1.2 landed the core primitives that 2.1, 2.2 and 2.3 were each budgeted to build. **All of Track 0 is done, and so is 1.2.** At six days a week that is a demo in about two weeks and a real client's guests on it in about three. **Engineering is the critical path**, and inside it **3.1 is the bottleneck**: no read path means no pricing, no availability and no door codes.

Track 0 — Today. Hours, not days.

Nothing here takes a full day, and three of the five unblock everything downstream. If only one thing happens today, make it 0.3.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
0.1	Set default branch to main [DONE]	NOW	Trivial	1 min	Anyone cloning today lands on a feature branch. Harmless now, confusing the moment branches drift.
0.2	Remove the client name from the golden set and fixtures [DONE]	NOW	Easy	0.25	Replaced with invented placeholders; eval still 87.5%. A hashed guard test now scans the whole repo, docs included — the name came back once in a sentence saying it had been removed. History rewrite still open.
0.3	Decide the receptionist intent vocabulary [DONE]	NOW	Easy	1 hr	19 intents, 84 examples, 5 languages, 38 tests, in packages/intents. Two bugs fixed on the way in: the fire trigger carried a Cyrillic lookalike and could never match, and the Franco-Arabic guard was dead code.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
0.4	Merge the eval branch [DONE]	NOW	Trivial	0.25	Verified conflict-free and green: +15 tests, 86 to 101, all passing. Runner, five measures, reports, recorded fixtures, plus the job queue. A merge commit, not a fast-forward — main has moved since.
0.5	Delete the stale nifty-johnson branch [DONE]	LOW	Trivial	1 min	Housekeeping your own roadmap already flagged.

Track 1 — Foundations. Week 1.

Do 1.1 before anything else is built. Every week it waits adds more call sites to change.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
1.1	Stop the core speaking WhatsApp — next up	NOW	Moderate	1.5	wa_message_id to external_id, wa_chat_id to thread_id, add a channel field. A phone call has no chat id. Now has an executable definition of done: KNOWN_LEAKS in test_boundary.py lists the 8 remaining files and fails on a stale entry. The ported envelope is the target shape to copy.
1.2	Port the four kept scaffold files [DONE]	HIGH	Moderate	1.0	All four live, no xfail, plus the core they exercise. All four traps closed. The boundary test now bans wa_, which is the leak “whatsapp” never matched. Quick-reply cap moved to the adapter — the scaffold’s own boundary test passed while its core enforced a WhatsApp limit.
1.3	Python 3.12 to 3.13	LOW	Easy	0.5	Baseline corrected: the repo is on 3.12, not 3.10. Upgrade surface checked and clean — no removed stdlib, no deprecated datetime calls. Do it after 1.1 so a breakage has one suspect, not two.

Track 2 — Make it a receptionist. Week 2.

This is the product. 2.1 is the only item with nothing in the repo to copy from.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
2.1	Conversations, tasks and slot filling — part done	HIGH	Hard	2.0	The state machine landed with 1.2 , reading its slots from the vocabulary. What is left: persistence, the conversations table, and the verification-codes table a door code needs. The v2 scaffold’s SQL already designs all of it.
2.2	The reply path — part done	HIGH	Moderate	1.5	Envelope and channel adapters landed with 1.2 . What is left: the composer, sending back out, and a fourth outcome in the orchestrator. Retries and dead-lettering already exist for CRM writes.
2.3	Autonomy gate — part done	HIGH	Easy	1.0	decide_autonomy landed with 1.2 , reading the ceiling from the vocabulary; money and owner matters are checked before confidence. What is left: wiring it into the orchestrator, and something that can actually prove identity.
2.4	Knowledge base	HIGH	Moderate	2.0	Facts table with sensitivity flags, prose in pgvector, and a real “I don’t know” that fetches a human. Door codes are not ordinary facts. For the demo, one property’s facts fit in the prompt — no retrieval needed.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
2.5	Prompt v2 and rewrite the golden set	MED	Moderate	1.0	Unblocked: 0.3 is done. Receptionist vocabulary, 8 cases rewritten and ~50 added. The runner from 0.4 already exists to score them. Watch the mixed-language number — it is 0% on the current 8.

Track 3 — Integration and launch. Week 3.

Base360.ai is ruled out as a partner: their product is substantially ours and their client base is closed to us. Hostaway, Guesty and Cloudbeds all publish APIs, so the capability is available without the strategic cost.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
3.1	PropertySystemPort plus the first adapter — the bottleneck	MED	Moderate	2.5	Build the port, not a Hostaway integration. Blocks pricing, availability <i>and</i> door codes: with no way to look up a booking, the identity check cannot run. <code>crm_cache</code> is the right shape; delivery is write-only, so this needs a new read port. Cache facts; never cache availability.
3.2	End to end on a real number, then measure	HIGH	Moderate	1.0	The point at which the eval number becomes real rather than recorded.

Runs in parallel — start on day one

None of these are engineering. All of them can quietly become the reason a date slips.

#	Work item	Urgency	Ease	Days	Why / what it unblocks
P1	Pick the first client	NOW	Easy	—	Decides which PMS adapter gets built first. Without it, 3.1 is a guess.
P2	Read the Hostaway / Guesty / Cloudbeds API docs, get sandbox keys	HIGH	Easy	0.5	Public docs, usually self-service sandboxes. Shape the port from what two or three of them offer <i>in common</i> .
P3	File Meta business verification	MED	Easy	1 hr	No longer blocking — unverified start is allowed, and a receptionist mostly replies inside the 24-hour window. File it anyway before volume makes it bind.
P4	Graphify as a build aid (optional)	LOW	Easy	0.5	Maps the repo for the coding agents during the 1.1 rename. Local parsing, no vector store, nothing leaves the machine. Install from the GitHub repo — several lookalike domains exist.

The dates

Milestone	When
Eval merged, name leak fixed, vocabulary decided	End of day 1
Core stops speaking WhatsApp; scaffold files ported	End of week 1
Holds a conversation and replies — rough demo	Middle of week 2
Knowledge and safety rules in — demo-ready	End of week 2
Live availability, measured, on a real number — pilot-ready	Middle of week 3
Phone answering	Week 4

Phone lands in week 4 rather than later because the speech-to-text seam already exists in `media/pipeline.py`. It was built for voice notes and turns out to be most of what a phone connector needs.

What would actually move these dates

The vocabulary decision drifting. One hour of founder time that blocks four items. If it slips a week, everything slips a week. This is the single highest-leverage hour on the whole plan.

Knowledge base scope creep. The 2.0 days assumes a structured intake form plus PMS sync. “Can it read our PDF handbook?” is a different and much larger project. Say no for now.

Quality, not features. Getting to *working* is two weeks. Getting to *trustworthy* — where it never invents a check-in time — is measured by the eval runner, and that number is not fully under your control. Budget a tuning tail.

PMS API access. Docs are public, but sandbox approval and rate limits are theirs to grant. Start P2 on day one; it is the new version of the Meta-verification lesson.

If you do only one thing today: decide the intent vocabulary (0.3) and merge the eval branch (0.4). One is an hour of thinking, the other is a code review. Together they unblock roughly half of everything below them.